

History of India's Independence

INDIAN Independence Day is a hugely significant national holiday for Indians, which marks the seminal moment the nation became independent from the United Kingdom.

This was officially declared on Aug 15, 1947, making this India's 75th Independence Day. Not only did India become independent on this day, but the country was divided into India and Pakistan.

Although unrest at colonial rule existed long before, the Indian independence movement gained momentum after the First World War. Mahatma Gandhi led the revolt against oppressive British rule and organised passive-resistance campaigns.

Although minor concessions were made by the British government, they were not enough. Discontent continued to grow in India, with nationalist leaders

such as Gandhi rejecting Britain's empty promises. In 1942, during the Second World War,

The Quit India Movement demanding an end to British rule was launched by the Indian Congress.

This led to colonial authorities arresting and jailing hundreds of nationalists, including Gandhi.

Despite these sentences, demonstrations grew after the war. Lord Louis Mountbatten, who was Viceroy in the country, had been given until 1948 to divide the nation, but this date was hastily moved forward.

His plan involved division along broadly religious lines - although it is up for debate how successful this was.

In 1947 the Indian National Congress reluctantly accepted the creation of Pakistan and, on Aug 15, 1947, the Indian Independence Bill took effect.

After the signing of the bill, it was agreed colonial India would be divided into two separate states - one with a Muslim majority (Pakistan) and the other with a Hindu majority (India).

The two countries celebrate on different days because Lord Mountbatten, had to attend the Pakistan celebration on Aug 14 and then travel to Delhi for India's first independence day on Aug 15.

On the eve of Independence Day, the president of India delivers an address to the nation from his office that is broadcast nationally.

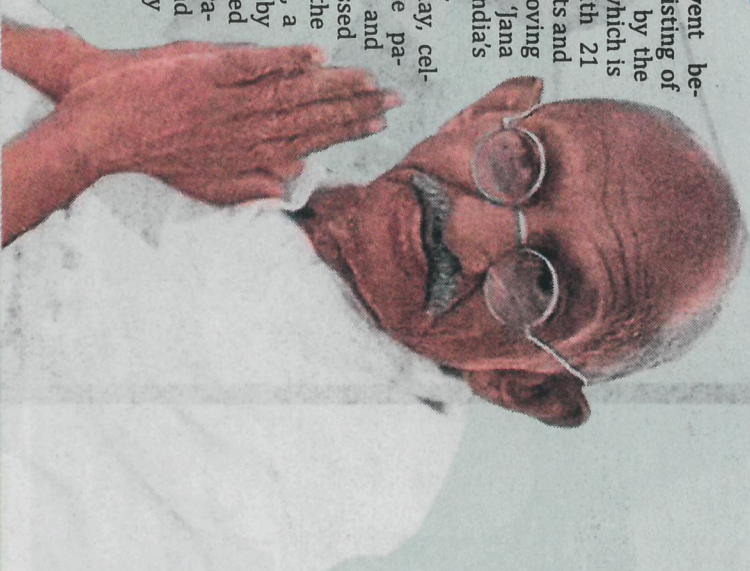
On the morning of Aug 15, the celebration kicks off with the arrival of the prime minister of India who receives a general salute from the guard of honour, which consists of representatives from the three wings of the Indian armed forces (army, navy and air force) and the Delhi police.

The main event begins with the hoisting of

the national flag by the prime minister, which is synchronised with 21 honorary gunshots and followed by a moving rendition of the 'Jana Gana Mana' (India's national anthem).

Later in the day, celebrations include patriotic parades and pageants focussed on honouring the freedom fighters, a march-past led by the Indian armed forces and paramilitary forces and performances by schoolchildren.

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Year-long celebrations to mark India's 75th Independence

INDIA will launch year-long celebrations for this year's independence to commemorate 75 years of Independence with a slew of programmes and projects to showcase 'development, governance, technology, reform, progress and policy' over the years.

The Prime Minister's Office has initiated an exhaustive exercise to frame a plan to commemorate the 75th year of Indian Independence. According to highly-placed sources, it will be a year-long grand celebration.

On the table are a host of projects ranging from energy efficient street lighting to command and control centres in all 100 smart cities to garbage-free 2,022 cities and the skilling programme for migrant workers.

The ministries have lined up projects which would be completed by August 2022 and inaugurated by Modi during the celebratory year. Smart City Mission has identified 163 projects to be inaugurated in the 75th year. Even Swachh Bharat Mission has lined up declaration.

Sources said the mega initiatives include installation of 75 solar trees in open areas, development of 10 selected parks as Platinum Jubilee Model Parks, Green Country Campaign planting 75,000 medicinal and fruit bearing plants, Global Tech Festival to showcase all technologies being used in India, lake redevelopment projects, development of river fronts, smart schools and digital libraries.

The culture ministry would be the nodal ministry for coordinating programmes like events at India Gate, special marathons and cultural evenings at various cities which played a role in India's freedom struggle. The culmination event could be a special session of Parliament in the newly-constructed Parliament building.

"It depends on the final plan. The new Parliament building is expected to be ready by August 2022," a senior official involved in the preparatory meetings, who did not wish to be identified said. — economictimes.indiatimes.com

Avoid crowded places and limit time in enclosed spaces

Maintain at least 1m distance from others

When possible, open windows and doors for ventilation

Keep hands clean and cover coughs and sneezes

Wear a mask



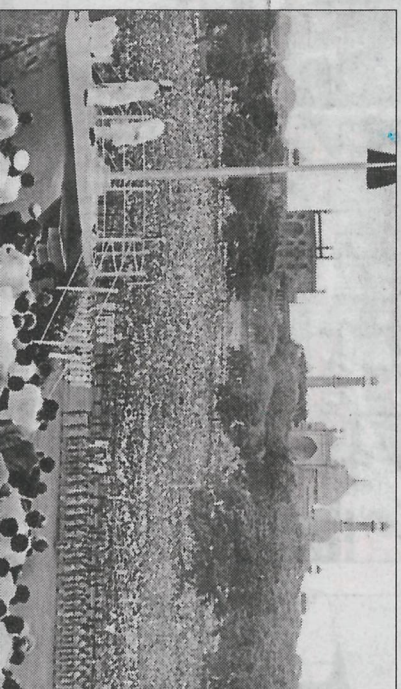
75th India Independence Day



Friday, August 13, 2021 | 33
National SUPPLEMENT



Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru during the Midnight session of the constituent assembly of India held on Aug 14-15, 1947.



The first Prime Minister of India Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru hoists the Indian national flag at the Red Fort on Aug 15, 1947.



The first Prime Minister of India, Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru, watches the crowd gathered to see him unfurling the Indian flag at the Red Fort on Aug 15, 1947.

“Let us sing the Indian National Anthem”

IN an effort to give chance to Indians living in Papua New Guinea to celebrate their special day - The Indian Independence, a web portal has been created where anyone can record and upload their own videos singing the national anthem.

Here are a few simple steps you can take to upload your videos and recordings on the web:

1. Open <https://rashtragaan.in>
2. Click “Proceed”
3. Enter your name, select age group and enter the Country name from where the video is being uploaded.
4. Click “Let’s Sing” or on the right click at bottom right (in case of mobile device)
5. Align face to screen
6. Press “Record”

The option for listening to the recording before uploading will be available. After satisfying with the recording, please press ‘Upload’.



Indian flag colours meaning and chakra significance explained

THE national flag was adopted in its present form during the meeting of Constituent Assembly held on the July 22, 1947, twenty-three days before India’s Independence on Aug 15, 1947.

There are three colours in the national flag - deep saffron (Kesar) at the top, white in the middle and dark green at the bottom in equal proportion.

In the centre of the white band is a navy-blue wheel which represents the Ashoka Chakra, which is a depiction of the Dharma Chakra, a wheel represented with 24 spokes. The ratio of the width of the flag to its length is two to three.

What does the saffron colour in our flag mean?

The saffron colour signifies the strength and courage of the country.

What does the white colour in the flag stand for?

The white colour indicates peace and truth.

What does the green colour in our flag represent?

The green colour shows the fertility, growth and auspiciousness of the land.

What does the Chakra stand for in the Indian flag?

The chakra shows that there is life in movement and death in stagnation.

- timesnownews.com



HIGH COMMISSION OF INDIA
PORT MORESBY

Independence Day Message



- High Commissioner
Mr. S. Inbasekar

At the outset, I would like to present my warm greetings to the Government and people of this paradise called Papua New Guinea. India is celebrating its 75th Independence Day on 15th August 2021. Government of India launched India@75 “Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav” on 12 March 2021 – 75 weeks before 15 August 2022 which will culminate on 15 August 2023. India@75 celebrations would be guided by five pillars, viz. Freedom Struggle, Ideas at 75, Achievements at 75, Actions at 75 and Resolves at 75. As Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi said at the launching ceremony “India@75 means *elixir of energy of independence - elixir of inspirations of the warriors of freedom struggle, elixir of new ideas and pledges and nectar of self-dependence*”.

The India@75 celebration is dedicated to the people of India in recognition of their role in the evolutionary journey of India so far. It is an embodiment of all that is progressive about India’s socio-cultural, political and economic identity.

India@75 present us with opportunities for our growing development partnership with Papua New Guinea in furtherance of its own growth aspirations. I sincerely hope that the warm relationship between India and PNG would continue to prosper and reach new heights during the celebrations of India@75.

Long live our ever deeper bilateral ties!

Tenk Yu Trui